

Agent skills

Skills are an open standard for extending agent capabilities. A skill is a folder containing a `SKILL.md` file with instructions that the agent can follow when working on specific tasks.

What are skills?

Skills are reusable packages of knowledge that extend what the agent can do. Each skill contains:

- **Instructions:** explicit protocols for how to approach a specific task.
- **Best practices:** conventions, style guidelines, and checklists to follow.
- **Scripts and resources:** optional helper scripts and data schemas the agent can execute.

When you start a conversation, the agent sees a list of available skills with their names and descriptions. If a skill looks relevant to your task, the agent reads the full instructions and follows them.

Note

Note: Antigravity defaults to `.agents/skills`, but still maintains backward compatibility for `.agent/skills`.

Anatomy of a skill

Skills are organized as directory bundles containing a required `SKILL.md` file:

```
my-skill/
├── SKILL.md      # Required skill instructions and metadata
├── scripts/      # Optional executable scripts
├── examples/     # Optional reference implementations
└── resources/    # Optional templates, schemas, or data files
```



```
name: code-review
description: Reviews code changes for bugs, style issues, and best
practices. Use when reviewing pull requests or checking code quality.

---

# Code Review Skill

When reviewing code, follow these steps:

## Review checklist

1. Correctness: verify that the code satisfies specifications.
2. Edge cases: ensure error conditions and boundaries are handled.
3. Style: follow project naming and architectural patterns.
4. Performance: identify potential bottlenecks or inefficiencies.
```

Frontmatter fields

The YAML frontmatter supports the following fields:

Field	Required	Description
<code>name</code>	No	A unique identifier for the skill (lowercase, hyphens for spaces). Defaults to the folder name if not provided.
<code>description</code>	Yes	A clear description of what the skill does and when to use it. This is what the agent sees when deciding whether to apply the skill.



Tip

Write your description in third person and include keywords that help the agent recognize when the skill is relevant. For example: “Generates unit tests for Python code using pytest conventions.”

How the agent uses skills

Skills follow a **progressive disclosure** pattern:

[Get Started](#)[Features](#)[SDK](#)[Changelogs ↗](#)[Blog ↗](#)

You don't need to explicitly tell the agent to use a skill—it decides based on context. However, you can mention a skill by name if you want to ensure it's used.

Best practices

Keep skills focused

Each skill should do one thing well. Instead of a “do everything” skill, create separate skills for distinct tasks.

Write clear descriptions

The description is how the agent decides whether to use your skill. Make it specific about what the skill does and when it's useful.

Use scripts as black boxes

If your skill includes scripts, encourage the agent to run them with `--help` first rather than reading the entire source code. This keeps the agent's context focused on the task.

Include decision trees

For complex skills, add a section that helps the agent choose the right approach based on the situation.

Skills by surface

Explore how to create and manage skills on your preferred surface:



Antigravity 2.0 loads skills from two primary locations.

Location	Scope
<code><workspace-root>/ .agents/skills/<skill-folder>/</code>	Workspace-specific
<code>~/.gemini/config/skills/<skill-folder>/</code>	Global (all workspaces)

- **Workspace skills:** scoped to a single project and committed to version control to share across your engineering team.
- **Global skills:** available across all projects on your workstation.

Invoking skills in Antigravity 2.0

- **Autonomous invocation:** the agent automatically reads and follows relevant skills based on your prompt.
- **Manual slash command:** type `/<skill-name>` in the prompt panel to explicitly invoke a skill.